



Batch production

When a number of the same items are made together, it is called batch production. One batch finishes each stage of the production process before the next batch starts, using the same equipment and steps.

How it works

Batch production allows a firm to make a quantity of items in one production run. Factory equipment is geared up in terms of scale and special tools that can be changed for each batch. For example, equipment is set up to make 200 size 8 dresses in red fabric and then adjusted to produce 400 size 10 dresses in blue fabric. Quantities can vary from as

few as four identical items for a local supplier to thousands for a department store, and batches can be made as often as required. Batch production is common in the food, clothing, footwear, paints, adhesive, and pharmaceutical ingredients industries. Each batch must be traceable, with clear date stamping, in order to comply with laws and standards.

Bread by the batch

Bread is commonly made in batches. A baker might make 100 white rolls, then 50 large brown loaves.

Mix bulk ingredients

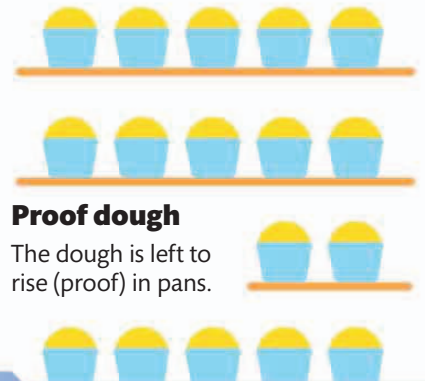
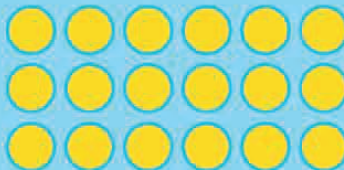
Ingredients for the batch of white rolls are mixed to form a dough.



Batch 1

Divide dough

After machine-mixing, the bulk dough is divided into small pans.



Proof dough

The dough is left to rise (proof) in pans.

Adjust for second batch

The equipment is recalibrated to make 50 large brown loaves. Bulk ingredients for the batch of brown bread are mixed to form a dough.



Batch 2

Divide dough

After machine-mixing, the bulk dough is divided into large pans.



Proof dough

The dough is left to rise (proof) in pans.

